

LearnedCircle Complete Investor Package

Summary PDF accompanying the editable business plan, pitch deck, financial model, investment memorandum, outreach kit, investor database, data room checklist and fundraising strategy.

Executive Summary

LearnedCircle is a flagship legal technology company building a trusted legal marketplace and professional network for Nigeria, with a staged path into Africa. LegalCircle operates as the legal content, professional publishing, debate and community network under the LearnedCircle ecosystem.

- Core users: clients, lawyers, law firms, employers, legal professionals, tax specialists, senior mentors and advertisers.
- Revenue: premium lawyer subscriptions, job and advert placements, featured listings, sponsored content, practice tools and future professional services.
- Fundraising frame: US\$250,000 to US\$1 million, or naira equivalent, to support hiring, marketing, verification, partnerships and product expansion.
- Equity options: N100,000,000 for 12%, N200,000,000 for 15%, and N500,000,000 for 20%.

Company Overview

LearnedCircle is positioned as the operating company and commercial platform. LegalCircle is positioned as the content and professional network layer, giving the brand a broader media, publishing, mentorship and professional engagement engine.

- LearnedCircle: lawyer discovery, premium profiles, client contact, jobs, advertising, invoices, admin workflows and verification.
- LegalCircle: articles, legal news, debates, guest blogs, mentorship notes, professional community and thought leadership.
- Ownership identity: powered by Advocati LP, with the Advocati LP logo to be added when supplied.

The Problem

Clients often struggle to identify credible lawyers. Lawyers struggle to build trusted digital visibility, receive quality briefs, publish professional insight, find opportunities and network beyond their immediate circle.

- Legal discovery remains fragmented across referrals, WhatsApp groups, search engines and informal networks.
- Young lawyers need mentorship, visibility and structured professional opportunities.
- Senior lawyers need a credible place to publish, mentor and build professional legacy.
- Employers and law firms need a cleaner channel for legal jobs, retainers and specialist opportunities.

Our Solution

LearnedCircle creates one trusted legal network where clients can find lawyers, lawyers can build visibility, and the profession can exchange knowledge and opportunities.

- Verified lawyer profiles with SCN, year of call, location, practice areas and public-contact preferences.
- Public client access without registration, including direct contact to active premium lawyers.
- Premium publishing for active verified premium lawyers, while free and non-premium accounts go through review.
- Mentorship visibility for senior lawyers and profile displays showing mentee following count.
- Lawyer dashboards with chat, notifications, invoices, article submission and profile management.

Products and Services

Product	Audience	Commercial Value
Verified profiles	Lawyers and clients	Trust, discovery, and profile credibility
Premium membership	Lawyers and firms	Recurring subscription revenue
LegalCircle content	Lawyers, clients, public	Audience growth and authority
Jobs and opportunities	Employers, firms, lawyers	Marketplace revenue and hiring utility
Mentorship	Senior and young lawyers	Community depth and professional value
Invoices	Lawyers and firms	Practice-tool stickiness and premium retention
Advertising	Legal brands and institutions	Campaign and sponsorship income

Market Analysis: Nigeria and Africa

Nigeria's lawyer population is commonly discussed in the 200,000 to 250,000 range. This plan uses a conservative 220,000 planning midpoint for modelling. The broader African opportunity comes from legal-market digitisation, business formalisation, cross-border commerce, professional mobility and growing demand for trusted online legal discovery.

- Nigeria first: build density with lawyers, law firms, NBA branches, clients and employers.
- Africa next: replicate the professional-network model in markets with strong English-speaking legal ecosystems and expanding digital adoption.
- Serviceable early market: verified Nigerian lawyers, commercial law practices, young lawyers, employers and legal institutions.
- Expansion markets to study: Ghana, Kenya, South Africa, Rwanda, Uganda and other common-law or business-facing jurisdictions.

Competitor Analysis

Competitor Type	What They Do	LearnedCircle Advantage
General search engines	Help users find law firms manually	Purpose-built legal profiles, verification and matching
Social media	Professional visibility and informal networking	Legal-specific workflows, moderation and structured discovery
Job boards	List vacancies	Legal-only opportunities plus lawyer profiles and applications
Traditional directories	Static listings	Publishing, chat, mentorship, invoices, adverts and content
WhatsApp/referrals	Informal trust networks	Searchable, documented and scalable professional network

Revenue Model

- Premium lawyer subscriptions at N10,000 monthly or N100,000 yearly.
- Featured lawyer placements and profile boosts.
- Employer job posting and opportunity adverts.
- Paid display adverts and sponsored legal content.
- Business invoice access bundled into premium and later expandable as a paid tool.
- Future revenue: CLE partnerships, institutional directories, recruitment services, data products and AI-assisted professional tools.

Marketing Strategy

- NBA branch outreach and targeted onboarding of respected senior lawyers.
- Founding mentor programme for SANs, retired judges, partners and senior practitioners.
- Content-led growth through LegalCircle articles, debate, legal news and guest blogs.
- Practice-area campaigns for corporate law, tax, property, employment, litigation, data protection, IP and arbitration.
- Employer partnerships with companies, law firms, startups and professional-service organisations.
- Referral loops: lawyers invite colleagues, mentees follow mentors, clients share successful searches.

Technology Stack

- Frontend: clean static-first web experience deployed on Vercel.
- Database and authentication foundation: Supabase.
- Email notifications: Resend, subject to domain verification and production configuration.
- Payments: payment provider integration planned for automatic premium activation after confirmed payment.
- Admin: moderation, lawyer verification, guest blog publishing, reports and premium-status oversight.
- Future: mobile app, AI legal assistant, analytics dashboards and secured document workflows.

Business Model

The model is subscription-first, marketplace-second. Recurring premium subscriptions provide predictable revenue, while jobs, adverts, sponsorships and professional tools increase average revenue per user.

- Free registration builds network volume.
- Verification and premium benefits create conversion pressure.
- Content and mentorship increase professional engagement.
- Jobs and adverts monetize marketplace traffic.
- Invoices and dashboards improve retention for lawyers and firms.

Five-Year Growth Strategy

Year	Priority	Expected Milestone
Year 1	Nigeria launch and credibility	First verified lawyers, premium users, jobs, content and mentors
Year 2	National expansion	NBA branch partnerships, employer pipeline and stronger content operation
Year 3	Product depth	Mobile app, AI assistant, advanced verification and firm tools
Year 4	Regional readiness	Pilot expansion into selected African markets
Year 5	Africa network	Multi-country legal professional network with institutional partnerships

Financial Projections

The base case assumes a 220,000 Nigerian lawyer planning market, 10% lawyer onboarding and 20% premium conversion among onboarded lawyers. Pricing uses N100,000 yearly premium membership for clean annualized modelling.

Scenario	Lawyers onboarded	Premium lawyers	Premium ARR	Jobs + adverts	Total annual potential
Conservative	11,000	1,100	N110m	N25m	N135m
Base case	22,000	4,400	N440m	N80m	N520m
Upside	44,000	13,200	N1.32bn	N200m	N1.52bn

Risk Analysis

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Slow lawyer adoption	Lower subscription growth	Founder-led outreach, branch partnerships, senior-lawyer credibility
Verification burden	Operational delays	Structured workflows, admin tools and staged verification standards
Trust and liability concerns	Reputational risk	Terms, disclaimers, professional conduct rules and reporting tools
Payment friction	Lower conversion	Automated activation, multiple payment channels and clear plan benefits
Competitive copying	Pressure on differentiation	Network effects, brand trust, content depth and legal-community focus

Exit Strategy

- Strategic acquisition by legal publishing, professional services, recruitment, fintech, SaaS or marketplace operators.
- Regional consolidation with other African professional-network platforms.
- Institutional partnership or majority investment by a legal services, education or compliance group.
- Long-term cash-flow business with recurring subscription and marketplace revenue.

Funding Requirements and Use of Funds

LearnedCircle seeks growth capital in the US\$250,000 to US\$1 million range, or naira equivalent. The proposed naira equity ladder is N100m for 12%, N200m for 15%, and N500m for 20%.

Use	Purpose	Indicative Allocation
Marketing and acquisition	Lawyer onboarding, NBA visibility, digital campaigns, employers	35%
Hiring and operations	Product, support, verification, content and partnerships	30%
Technology	Payments, mobile app, AI assistant, analytics and security	20%
Legal, compliance and admin	Documentation, policies, accounting and governance	10%
Reserve	Contingency and working capital	5%